

is: an MSI KT4 Ultra SR, 333 FSB motherboard with VIA Technologies Inc VT8377 chipset, Apollo KT400 CPU to PCI Bridge, A6590VMS V1.1 091102 AMIBIOS Version 3.31a, an AMD Athlon XP 2600+, 2.083 GHz, 333 MHz FSB processor, Kingston DDR 512 MB, 333 MHz RAM, Seagate Barracuda ST380011A, 80 GB, 7,200-rpm hard drive, SMEDIA nVIDIA GeForce MX 440 SE, 64 MB DDR w/TV, AGP 4X graphics card—all running Windows 98 (C Drive) and Windows XP (D Drive). I also have an ibox cabinet, a 300 W power supply and an APC Back-UPS UPS.

The problem is that my AMD Athlon XP 2600+ runs only at 1.90 GHz, when it should run at 2.083 GHz. The CPU performance is also at par with an Athlon XP processor running at 1.90 GHz, which I tested with the SiSoft Sandra 2003 Standard software I got from your June 2003 CD.

In the BIOS setup (AMIBIOS New Setup Utility 3.31a), the current values set under the 'Frequency / Voltage Control' sub-menu are as follows:

Spread Spectrum: Disabled (other available options: ± 0.25 , ± 0.5 , ± 0.75), CPU FSB

Clock: 280 MHz (100 to 280 - in steps of 1)
CPU Ratio: Auto ($\times 6.0$ to 12.0 - in steps of 0.5, 14.0, 15.0, 12.5 $\times$ 13.0)

CPU Vcore (V): Auto (1.625, 1.650, 1.675, 1.700, 1.725, 1.750)

DDR Voltage (V): Auto (2.6, 2.7, 2.8)

Termination Voltage (V): Auto (1.27, 1.29)

AGP Voltage (V): Auto (1.6, 1.7, 1.8)

I have also observed that when the CPU FSB Clock speed was set at default value of 100 MHz, the processor was being recognised as an Athlon 1.25 GHz; and when the speed was set at 266, the processor got recognised as an Athlon 2000+, 1.67 GHz. Now the CPU FSB Clock speed is set at the maximum available option of 280, and the processor is recognized as a 2600+, running at 1.90 GHz.

Tell me how to get my processor to work at its designated speed of 2.083 GHz.

S. Sinha

A Wow! Now that's a complete list of specifications if we ever saw one. You certainly did your homework, and all the troubleshooting possible. Here's the dampner—there's nothing wrong with your processor. It's running at the correct speed. There are two versions of the AMD Athlon 2600+ available in the market. You have the latest version with 333 MHz FSB and 512 KB L2 cache; this runs at a clock speed of 1917 MHz or 1.9 GHz.

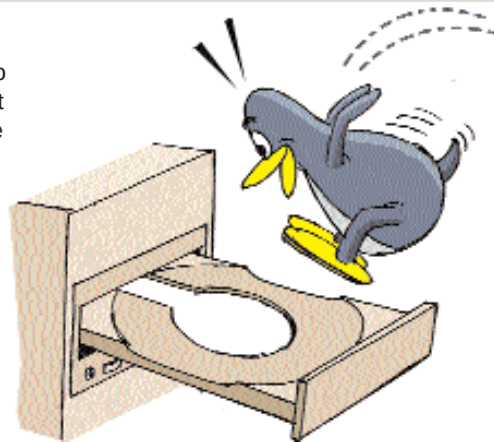
Temporary Linux

Q I run Windows XP, and want to know how to run Linux without overwriting XP. Can I run it off the CD without installing it, or do I require a bootable CD?

Mahesh I

A Yes, you can run Linux without installing it. If you have the August 2003 issue of Digit, use the Linux DVD to create a bootable CD of Knoppix—a Linux distribution meant for users who want to try Linux without taking the risk of installing it. Just pop the bootable Knoppix CD into your drive, and boot into Linux. However, you cannot do this with any of the other Linux distributions (Red Hat, SuSE, Mandrake,

etc). Once you're convinced that you want to run Linux, take a look at the 'Boots in Control' article on page 137 of this issue to learn how to install both Linux and Windows XP safely.



The older models clocked 2.13 GHz, but ran at 266 FSB with 256 KB of L2 cache. Check the AMD processor box, and you will see the clock speeds in the fine print near the bar-code. The Athlon XP 2800+ runs at 2.083 GHz.

Downloading tutorials

Q I want to learn 3D software such as Maya, 3D Studio Max, Softimage, etc. I have visited many of the tutorials sites on the Net, which have online tutorials in the form of Quick Time movies. How can I save or download these movies to view them later?

Sunil

A This is easily done by using such programs as Download Accelerator (DAP), downloadable from www.downloadaccelerator.com. DAP operates in the background, and traps the Web links that point

to these files, thus allowing you to download them. Make sure you're not violating a site's copyright, or breaking any piracy laws by doing this. Read the fine print on the site to be sure.